

Nikita Starodubcev

Personal page: quickjkee.github.io/personal-page

Email: nstarodubtsev@hse.ru

GitHub: github.com/quickjkee

Relevant skills: Python, PyTorch, Docker, Git, Latex.

Research interests: Efficient image generation, diffusion and few-step models, image editing.

Languages: English (fluent), Russian (native).

EDUCATION

HSE University, PhD student, Computer Science Nov 2023 – Nov 2026 (expected)
Supervisor: [Artem Babenko](#)

ITMO University, M.S. in Computer Science Sep 2021 – Jul 2023
Supervisor: [Nikolay Nikitin](#), GPA: 5.0/5.0

Saint Petersburg State University, B.S. in Physics Sep 2017 – Jul 2021
Supervisor: [Evgeny Yarevsky](#), GPA: 4.8/5.0

EXPERIENCE

Adobe Research, *Research Intern* May 2025 – Aug 2025
Worked on improving the generation quality of diffusion models.
Hosted by [Zhe Lin](#), [Zongze Wu](#), and [Daniil Pakhomov](#)

Yandex Research, *Research Scientist* Nov 2022 – Present
Working on accelerating diffusion models for image generation and editing.

AIM Club ITMO, *Software Engineer* Dec 2021 – Jun 2023
Created and developed the open-source framework [GEFEST](#).

PUBLICATIONS

- **N. Starodubcev**, D. Pakhomov, Z. Wu, I. Drobyshevskiy, Y. Liu, Z. Wang, Y. Zhou, Z. Lin, D. Baranchuk “[Rethinking Global Text Conditioning in Diffusion Transformers](#)”, [ICLR 2026](#)
- **N. Starodubcev**, D. Kuznedelev, A. Babenko, D. Baranchuk, “[Scale-wise Distillation of Diffusion Models](#)”, [ICLR 2026](#)
[Contributed to the diffusers library](#) (new [scheduler](#) is added)
- **N. Starodubcev**, M. Khoroshikh, A. Babenko, and D. Baranchuk, “[Invertible Consistency Distillation for Text-Guided Image Editing in Around 7 Steps](#)”, [NeurIPS 2024](#)
The proposed approach was integrated into [YandexART](#) giving [4x speedup](#)

- **N. Starodubcev**, D. Baranchuk, A. Fedorov, and A. Babenko, “[Your Student is Better Than Expected: Adaptive Teacher-Student Collaboration for Text-Conditional Diffusion Models](#)”, CVPR 2024
- **N. Starodubcev**, D. Baranchuk, V. Khrulkov, and A. Babenko, “[Towards real-time text-driven image manipulation with unconditional diffusion models](#)”, *arXiv preprint, 2023*
- **N. Starodubcev**, N. Nikitin, E. Andronova, K. Gavaza, D. Sidorenko, A. Kaluzhnaya, “[Generative design of physical objects using modular framework](#)”, Engineering Applications of Artificial Intelligence, 2023

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Yandex School of Data Analysis, *Lecturer*

Apr – May 2025

Delivered four lectures for the course “Visual Generative Modeling” on modern visual generative models.

Yandex School of Data Analysis, *Lecturer*

Nov 2024

Taught the “CV Week” course on deep understanding of diffusion models. Lecture and seminar ([1](#), [2](#)) delivered in Russian.

AI 360: Yandex and SBER, *Mentor*

Feb 2024

Mentored students from top-tier Russian universities ([HSE](#), [MIPT](#)) on the personalization of diffusion models.